chief beg, Sherak Arghūn, was lying along the Bārān and he had led an army out to deter ‘Abdu’r-razzāq Mīrzā from passing along the Panjhīr-road after he had fled from Kābul. He had been lying along with Tarkalānī Afghāns towards Lamghān. Without any delay, Babur marched forward in the afternoon. He pressed on through the dark till the dawn. And then, they surmounted the Hūpīān-pass.

Babur came out of the pass and above stood a star too bright in lustre. Looking at it inquisitively, Babur said, ‘May, not that be Suhail?’ [4] Bāqī Chaghānīānī replied, ‘It is Suhail,’ and read the couplet mentioned in the preface of *Anwār-i-suhailī:* [* †]

> How far dost thou shine, O Suhail, and where dost thou rise?
> A sign of good luck is thine eye to the man on whom it may light.

Babur had never seen Suhail.

By the time they reached Sanjid Valley, the sun had already reached dusk and had just set in. They dismounted there. The scouts sent by Babur to Sherak, Muqīm’s chief beg, below the Qarā-bāgh, had caught up with him near Aīkarī-yār. After a little fight with Sherak and his people, Babur’s men got the upper hand. They hurried their adversaries off unhorsing at least eighty soldiers and imprisoning them.

Babur forgave him and chose not to kill him despite popular opinion being otherwise. Finally, Sherak took service with Babur.

Walī, Brother of Khusrau Shāh Dies and Kābul Is Gained

There were various tribes and clans and half a dozen bodies[5] of the Moghūl horde, which Khusrau Shāh had left in Qūndūz. He was reluctant to even think about their condition and it would bring him many troubles in the future. One such was Rūstā-hazāra from Badakhshān. He traversed the Panjhīr-pass to this camp with Sayyidīm ‘Alī darbān. He showered Babur with obeisance and committed to serve him.

One person under Ayūb Yūsuf and Ayūb Bihlūl submitted to Babur. Soon came another one from Khutlān, under Khusrau Shāh’s younger brother, Walī. The next one consisted of the Moghūl tribesmen, Aīmāq who had been in parts of Yīlānchaq, Nikdiri and the Qūndūz. At the Sar-i-āb the tribesmen were ahead and Walī was behind. They blocked his route and thrashed him. Walī, with the hope of a rescue and to stay safe, fled to the Aūzbegs. But unfortunately, Shaybāni Khān got hold of him and had him beheaded at a square in